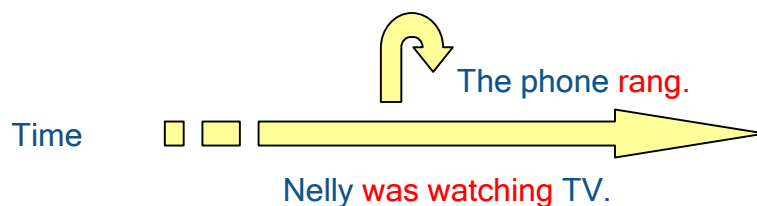


THE PAST CONTINUOUS

Study these sentences:

Yesterday evening Nelly **watched** TV **from seven o' clock until ten**.
While she **was watching** TV , the phone rang.
It **was** John: He **asked** her out.

We use the **Past Continuous** to say that someone was **in the middle of doing** something. For a **completed action** we use the **Simple Past**.



The Past continuous is often used to describe **the background activity** against which something suddenly happened.

More examples:

John **came home** while we **were having** dinner.

When I **was walking** in the park yesterday I **met** an old friend.

The Past continuous is formed with the auxiliary **was/ were** + **ing** form of the **main verb**.

I / he, she / it we / you / they	was were	walking watching working listening
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More on the difference between the Past Simple and the Past Continuous.
Look at the situation:

Jim Hale, the detective, **opened** the door and **entered** the room. It **was** dark, so he **switched** on the light. Loud music **was playing** on the radio. A man **was lying** motionless on the floor. There **was** blood all over the carpet. The window **was** open and the curtains **were fluttering** in the wind. Jim **ran** across the room. He **felt** the man's pulse. The victim **was** dead. Jim **walked** quickly over to the window and **looked** out. As he **was standing** there the telephone **started** to ring. He **picked** up the receiver. "Hello", he **said**. Nobody **answered**. He could hear that somebody **was breathing** heavily. Then there **was** a click. Somebody **ended** the call....